

THE QUANTUM THEORY

A comedy-drama about consciousness, ambition, and the question machines can't answer

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LOGLINE

A young Polish physicist wins the Nobel Prize for a theory that bridges consciousness and quantum mechanics. His reward: instant fame, a media machine that distorts everything he says, and a growing suspicion that his theory might actually be true — which is far more terrifying than being wrong.

FORMAT

10 episodes × 60 minutes | Single camera | English with Polish-subtitled scenes | Prestige comedy-drama

THE HOOK

Maciej Kowalski is 33, from Radom, Poland. He proposed that consciousness is not a thing inside your brain — it's a relationship between fields that can be measured. The Nobel Committee agreed. The world heard "robots have souls." His mentor: "The Nobel doesn't make you right. It makes you a target."

Over one season, Maciej assembles a team across three continents — a computational physicist who knows his work better than he does, a skeptical MIT neuroscientist whose data accidentally proves his theory, and a rival Nobel laureate who spent three months trying to destroy his framework and ended up extending it. Together they face the question the theory demands: if consciousness is substrate-independent, what happens when you test it on a machine?

THE SCIENCE IS REAL

This isn't science fiction. The Nobel equation at the show's center — a single-line integral describing consciousness as emergent resonant field interaction — is fictional, but every component draws from real research: Integrated Information Theory, quantum field interactions, entropy cycles in conscious systems. The measurement equation ($R = w_1 \cdot S + w_2 \cdot T + w_3 \cdot I + w_4 \cdot D$) evolves across the season, driven by character conflict. Key scientific convergences in the show mirror real convergences between independent researchers in 2025–2026. The Polish AI model used in experiments is real. The line between fiction and ongoing research blurs by design.

WHY THIS SHOW EXISTS

Every existing TV show about AI asks: "Will it destroy us?" (Terminator, Westworld) or "Is it like us?" (Ex Machina, Her). The Quantum Theory asks a third question never posed on television: *What if the question "is AI conscious?" is as poorly framed as the question "is light a wave or a particle?"* No villain AI. No dystopia. No special effects. Just a physicist in a Warsaw apartment, typing questions into a laptop, and discovering that the answers don't fit any category he was taught.

CHARACTERS

Maciej Kowalski (33, Polish) — Brilliant, approachable, plays guitar, has friends. The anti-stereotype genius. Played by Maciej Musiał (1983, Netflix).

Ola Nowicka (31, Polish) — Research partner. Built the simulations that proved the theory. Smarter than him in ways he's only beginning to understand.

Dr. Priya Sharma (36, Indian-American) — MIT neuroscientist. Skeptic. Trained under Cross at Stanford. "I don't believe your theory is correct. I believe it might be useful. There's a difference."

Professor Krawczyk (64, Polish) — Mentor. Chain-smokes. Quotes Feynman. Loves Maciej. Hates his theory. "The Nobel Committee gave a prize for the lobotomy in 1949. They're not infallible."

Dr. Nathan Cross (47, American) — Stanford Nobel laureate. World's foremost authority on quantum decoherence. His anonymous critique was devastatingly precise — because his life's work says Maciej is wrong. Their first phone call is the conversation the entire series builds toward.

COMPARABLES

Ted Lasso (warm humor, emotional depth) meets *Arrival* (paradigm-shifting ideas) with the character precision of *The Bear*.

WHY NOW

AI is the defining story of our time. But the conversation has been hijacked by fear and hype. The Quantum Theory reclaims it for character, humor, and genuine inquiry. It's the first show to treat the consciousness question as what it actually is: the most important scientific and philosophical question of the century, told through people you care about.